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PRESIDENT MEETS INDIA'S NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISER

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received Ajit Doval, National Security Adviser of India, on Saturday. The meeting, which was also attended by Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, addressed developments in the Middle East and their serious implications for regional and international security and stability, as well as global energy security.

Gargash: Rebuilding trust with Iran could take generations

'There is a clear distinction between restoring relations and restoring trust'

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said rebuilding trust between Iran and countries in the region would take "a very long time", stressing that there is a clear distinction between restoring relations and restoring trust after sustained attacks.

Speaking at a public policy conference hosted by the French Institute of International Relations, Gargash said it was unrealistic to speak of trust after the launch of around 2,800 missiles and drones. "Rebuilding relations is one thing; rebuilding trust is something entirely different," he said, adding that the wounds left by the attacks could take "generations" to heal.

Iran attacks fallout

He warned that the fallout would shape Iran's standing in the region over the long term, with Gulf states now viewing Tehran as a persistent strategic threat. The attacks, he said, appeared deliberate and underscored Iran's disregard for Arab relations. According to Gargash, roughly 90 per cent of the strikes targeted civilian areas and energy infrastructure, contradicting Iranian claims that military sites were the primary focus.

Gargash said Iran is facing a political impasse, pointing to a fragmented and poorly coordinated government. He warned against interpreting the current pause in negotiations as a victory, saying such a reading could further complicate efforts to stabilise the situation.

Talks with US, Russia

Meanwhile, Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, held a phone call with Marco Rubio, US Secretary of State, to discuss the latest regional developments.

The two sides reviewed the repercussions of the unprovoked and terrorist Iranian missile attacks targeting the UAE and a number of countries in the region, and their impact on international peace and security, energy supplies, maritime security, and global economic stability.

Earlier, Sheikh Abdullah also received a call from Sergey Lavrov, Minister of Foreign Affairs of Russia. The ministers reviewed a range of regional issues and challenges, and ways to advance de-escalation efforts and reach solutions that ensure peace, development and sustainable prosperity for their peoples.

SEE ALSO P9,16

Gunman targeted Trump officials

Officer injured in shootout as agents rush Trump and press gala guests to safety

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Investigators believe the gunman who attempted to storm a high-profile dinner attended by Donald Trump was targeting senior members of the administration, US officials said yesterday, as scrutiny intensified over security at the event.

Acting Attorney General Todd Blanche said early findings suggest the suspect intended to attack "members of the administration," though no clear motive has yet been established. The attacker, identified as Cole Tomas Allen, 31, was armed with a shotgun, handgun and knives when he charged a security checkpoint

at the Washington Hilton, where the White House Correspondents' dinner was underway.

Secret Service agents quickly subdued him after an exchange of gunfire. One officer was shot at close range but survived due to a bulletproof vest. Trump was rushed from the ballroom as guests, including Melania Trump and Vice-President JD Vance, took cover. Trump struck a philosophical tone, linking repeated threats to his political impact.

"The people that make the biggest impact, they're the ones

that they go after," he said, referencing past assassinations, including that of Abraham Lincoln.

Trump, who survived an assassination attempt at an election rally in 2024, added that "I lead a pretty normal life, considering, you know, it's a dangerous life."

"A lot of other people, you know, you read stories where they become basket cases. To be honest, I'm not a basket case."

Blanche said the suspect had legally purchased the firearms.

— with inputs from agencies
SEE ALSO P15

UAE CONDEMNS ATTACK TARGETING TRUMP

The UAE has strongly condemned the armed attack targeting President Donald Trump of the United States, expressing deep regret over the incident. In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs affirmed the UAE's solidarity with President Trump and his family, as well as with the government and people of the United States.

It also strongly denounced such criminal acts, reiterating the UAE's firm rejection of all forms of violence, extremism and terrorism that seek to undermine security and stability.

—WAM

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, has approved the establishment of a Dh1 billion national fund to support vital industries.

"We have approved a package of initiatives and decisions to support the national industrial sector, including the establishment of a national fund worth Dh1 billion for industrial resilience, aimed at advancing the localisation of vital industries, strengthening supply chain resilience, and accelerating the adoption of artificial intelligence technologies in production, operations and planning," Sheikh Mohammed wrote on his X account.

The fund will focus on supporting critical industries, particularly those linked to national priorities such as food security and essential manufacturing.

It also aims to boost local production capacity, build strategic reserves of key industrial goods and strengthen value chains across priority sectors.

AI to play key role

Artificial intelligence will play a key role in the initiative, supporting predictive analytics, risk management and operational efficiency, while helping industrial entities respond more effectively to shifting economic and geopolitical conditions.

Alongside the fund, Sheikh Mohammed approved a policy to enhance the presence of UAE-made products across retail outlets and e-commerce platforms.

The policy is intended to increase consumer awareness, strengthen demand for locally manufactured goods and enable national factories to integrate

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Focus on food security and essential manufacturing
- Boost to local output and strategic reserves
- AI to drive analytics, risk control and efficiency
- 'Made in UAE' push across retail and e-commerce
- Phase 1 for essentials: dairy, eggs, poultry, bread, flour, oils, vegetables
- Aim to stabilise supply and lift demand for local goods
- In-Country Value rule extended across federal entities
- Target to localise 5,000+ key products
- 'Make it in the Emirates 2026' to draw 120,000+ visitors
- 1,000+ exhibitors; SMEs make up 61%
- New AI-led quality platform, procurement push and start-up hub
- 'House of Industry' to track UAE's industrial rise

more effectively into major supply chains.

The first phase will focus on essential products with scalable local production, including bottled water, dairy products, eggs, fresh and chilled poultry, bread, flour, locally packaged vegetable oils, and seasonal vegetables. The initiative also seeks to stabilise local markets by encouraging consistent demand and ensuring the continuity of supply, reinforcing the competitiveness of domestic industries.

The Vice-President also approved the expansion of the National In-Country Value Programme, making it mandatory across all federal government entities and national companies.

The programme is expected to further drive local procurement and support the UAE's ambition to fully localise more than 5,000 vital products.

Sheikh Mohammed confirmed that preparations are under way for the launch of the fifth edition of the "Make it in the Emirates 2026" platform, scheduled to take place in Abu Dhabi. The event is expected to attract over 120,000 visitors, including investors, manufacturers, policymakers and global industry leaders.

Over 1,000 exhibitors representing 12 industrial sectors will participate, with small and medium-sized enterprises accounting for around 61 per cent of them.

New initiatives

The platform will introduce several new initiatives, including the launch of a national quality infrastructure platform to enhance the competitiveness of UAE products and support their readiness for global markets through AI-enabled solutions. In addition, the "House of Industry" will be launched as a national museum documenting the evolution of the UAE's industrial sector.

The Cabinet approved the establishment of a National Industrial Data Committee, chaired by Hasan Jassim Al Nowais, Undersecretary of the Ministry of Industry and Advanced Technology, to identify priority industrial data, accelerate its availability, strengthen integration with national systems, address data challenges, and propose solutions to ensure real-time access, including required legislative updates.

NATION
RTA launches new major road projects to ease Dubai traffic | P4

UNITED IN STRENGTH
MBRGI spends Dh2.3b in 2025, reaching 165m people worldwide | P6

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Veteran Indian businessman Vasu Shroff dies aged 85

Founder of Regal Traders contributed to community development in UAE

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Veteran Indian businessman Vasu Shroff, founder of Regal Traders, has died at 85, company officials confirmed.

The Shroff family said: "With deep regret, we inform of the sad demise of our beloved father." Funeral services are scheduled at New Sonapur Crematorium in Dubai today, with a separate memorial at Grand Hyatt Hotel later this week.

Shroff was a pioneer of the UAE's textile trade and a prominent figure in the Indian



Gulf News Archives

■ Vasu Shroff

diaspora. He contributed to community development, supporting institutions such as The Indian High School, India Club, and Hindu temples in Dubai.

Business leaders and community figures described him as generous and influential. Tributes highlighted his role in shaping Dubai's commercial landscape and supporting charitable initiatives globally. His legacy spans business, philanthropy and community leadership.

SEE ALSO P10